

KAVINRAJ BASKARAN

PRODUCT MANAGER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product Manager with a Master's in Software Engineering and a foundation in QA that shapes how I think about risk, edge cases, and delivery. Experienced in owning product across multiple platforms, leading enterprise-scale migrations, and building new modules from scratch while maintaining consistent release cadence without compromising quality. Work closely with C-suite and engineering, with a product-first mindset and a genuine focus on solving real problems for the merchants using what we build.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategy & Discovery: Product Roadmapping, Continuous Product Discovery, Problem Framing, User Research & Validation, Release Planning

Delivery Frameworks: User Story Writing, Acceptance Criteria Definition, Backlog Management & Prioritization, Trade-off Analysis

Product Leadership: Stakeholder Engagement, Cross-functional Collaboration, OKR Alignment, Developer & UX/UI Team Syncing

Quality & Risk: Customer-Centric Design Thinking, QA-Informed Risk Mitigation, Feature Flagging, Edge Case Analysis, Compliance Integration

EDUCATION

- Master of Computer Science (MSc) in Software Engineering, Multimedia University, Cyberjaya
- Bachelor of Computer Science (BSc) in Software Engineering, Multimedia University, Cyberjaya

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

Product Management: JIRA, ClickUp, Lark, Confluence, Backlog Management, Roadmapping, Release Management, App Store Connect

Design & Collaboration: Figma, Lark Docs, Confluence

Delivery Practices: Problem Framing, Continuous Product Discovery, PRD Writing, User Story Writing, Acceptance Criteria Definition, BDD, Gherkin, Feature Flag Rollout, UAT, Multi-platform Release Management

Platforms: Web Applications, Mobile Apps (iOS/Android), POS Devices

LANGUAGES

English: Advanced, Bahasa Melayu: Fluent, Tamil: Native

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Manager, FeedMe Feb 2025 – Present

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

- **Executive Partnership:** Report directly to the CTO, partnering closely with him and the wider C-suite on product direction, prioritization, and strategic decisions.
- **Continuous Product Discovery:** Lead modern product planning and discovery loops, seamlessly aligning business goals, customer pain points, and technical feasibility.

- **Backlog Ownership:** Manage and dynamically prioritize the product backlog based on data-driven insights, product analytics, and strategic business impact.
- **Stakeholder Alignment:** Collaborate with cross-departmental stakeholders to gather, validate, and refine complex product requirements into clear feature definitions.
- **Product Specification:** Conduct in-depth requirement analysis to ensure absolute clarity, technical scalability, and alignment with product North Star metrics.
- **Engineering Partnership:** Partner closely with engineering teams throughout iterative sprint cycles, providing clear user stories, removing blockers, and streamlining delivery.
- **Risk & Quality Frameworks:** Inject a QA-informed mindset into early product discovery, proactively defining rigorous acceptance criteria and identifying edge cases to minimize technical debt.
- **Compliance & Governance:** Integrate vital business rules and compliance standards directly into feature discovery, product design, and final delivery workflows.
- **Knowledge Management:** Maintain centralized, transparent documentation for features, product decisions, and internal/external release communications to foster alignment.
- **Dual-Track Agile Leadership:** Facilitate highly collaborative cross-functional loops between UI/UX design, engineering, QA, and business growth teams to maintain delivery momentum.
- **Team Scaling:** Participated actively in the talent acquisition process by conducting technical and behavioral interviews to evaluate engineering and product management candidates.
- **Remote Team Optimization:** Maintained high productivity standards and established robust asynchronous communication frameworks while operating effectively in a distributed team structure.

Senior Software QA Engineer, FeedMe *Mar 2023 – Jan 2025*

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

- **Agile Delivery:** Enhanced team collaboration and delivery flexibility by championing iterative development cycles within an Agile environment.
- **Shift-Left Testing:** Implemented Shift-Left testing strategies to identify, log, and resolve software defects early in the delivery cycle, drastically reducing production issues.
- **Omnichannel Quality:** Managed comprehensive quality assurance protocols ensuring seamless feature integration across website portals, Point-of-Sale (POS) devices, and mobile applications.
- **Defect Analytics:** Orchestrated end-to-end defect tracking and verification workflows, providing constructive feedback loops to engineering teams to improve overall product health.
- **Pre-Development Reviews:** Evaluated user stories and UI/UX designs prior to engineering sprints, offering critical feedback on usability, edge cases, and technical constraints.
- **Test Architecture:** Authored detailed, behavior-driven development (BDD) test plans using the Gherkin method alongside robust regression test strategies.
- **Test Automation:** Programmed and maintained automated test scripts in Python utilizing Selenium, and deployed Ghost Inspector for efficient regression testing.
- **Exploratory Testing:** Executed target-driven exploratory testing to uncover complex user experience anomalies missed by automated and scripted workflows.

QA Engineer, ServisHero *Apr 2022 – Feb 2023*

Selangor, Malaysia

Software Tester *Aug 2020 – Mar 2022*

Selangor, Malaysia

Software Tester, Prudential Assurance Malaysia Berhad (PAMB) *Mar 2020 – Jun 2020*

KEY PROJECTS AS A PRODUCT MANAGER - FEEDME

Enterprise Inventory Migration & Multi-Country Expansion, ZUS Coffee

Led end-to-end product ownership for FeedMe's largest enterprise client, migrating ZUS Coffee's full inventory operations from their legacy system into FeedMe's platform across roughly 1,000 outlets in Malaysia, then driving international expansion across 4 countries with distinct operational, compliance, and localisation requirements.

Malaysia Migration

- Owned full inventory migration roadmap: data mapping, planning, go-live, and post-migration support.
- Identified and closed feature gaps to meet ZUS Coffee's enterprise-grade operational needs.
- Managed NetSuite ERP integration.
- Led weekly stakeholder engagement with ZUS Coffee's ops and tech teams.
- Coordinated staff training across outlets for go-live readiness.
- Reviewed product-related bug reports.

International Expansion: Thailand, Indonesia, Pakistan, Singapore (in progress)

- Rolled out the same core inventory product across all countries, each with different operational workflows and localisation needs.
- Adapted product configuration per country to accommodate local regulatory requirements and operational differences without rebuilding core infrastructure.
- Managed multi-country stakeholder alignment, working across different ZUS teams and time zones simultaneously.
- Ensured all markets went fully live on FeedMe's inventory system.

Outcome

- Roughly 1,000 Malaysian outlets, ~15 Thailand outlets, 1 Indonesian outlet, and 1 Pakistan outlet successfully migrated and live. ~15 Singapore outlets migration is in progress.
- NetSuite ERP integration fully operational.
- Single product adapted across 5 markets with different compliance, localisation, and operational requirements, with more countries coming soon.

Central Kitchen Module, New Feature Build (0 to 1)

In progress, nearing completion. Identified a gap in FeedMe's inventory offering: operators running central kitchens had no digital system to manage production and distribution to outlets. Took full product ownership to design and ship this module from scratch.

- Conducted user research before any development began.
- Designed the full end-to-end product flow and wrote the PRD.
- Scoped deliberately for MVP: shipped fast, validated with real users, and built further based on feedback.
- Worked directly with engineers throughout the build.

- Personally QA-tested the module before release.
- Structured a controlled phased release to selected operators before full rollout.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

Operational Efficiency

- Automated a previously manual outlet onboarding process in collaboration with engineering, scaling throughput from 10 to 75 outlets per month, a 7.5x improvement.
- Cut onboarding time by 55%, from 2 hours for 10 outlets down to 1.5 hours for 35 outlets.
- Built a centralised bug reporting pipeline used by 20+ Account Managers, replacing informal group chat reporting with a structured workflow that reduced missed reports and gave engineers clearer visibility on issues to resolve.
- Built a task management dashboard for the engineering team, consolidating task ownership, due dates, and requirement details in one place, reducing back and forth and keeping sprints on track.

Process & Documentation

- Established internal documentation standards ensuring external stakeholders and support teams have clear operating guides for every new feature shipped.
- Runs daily standups with the engineering team, maintaining alignment across sprint progress, blockers, and upcoming releases.
- Produces platform-specific release notes for each deployment across Portal, POS, and iOS/Android App, ensuring merchants have clear visibility on what has changed with every version update.

Product Vision & Delivery

- Managed controlled phased rollout using feature flags, enabling gradual merchant onboarding and reducing release risk for critical features.
- Manages weekly release cadence across 3 platforms, Portal, POS, and iOS/Android App, including coordinating version-dependent rollouts where POS and app updates need to be sequenced before going live.
- Acts as gatekeeper for the product roadmap; every requirement is reviewed against real merchant value before moving forward into development.
- Supported onboarding of multiple enterprise merchants beyond flagship clients, managing varied operational requirements across accounts.

LEADERSHIP & MODERN WAYS OF WORKING

- **Enterprise Delivery Mindset:** As FeedMe expanded from serving SME merchants to onboarding large enterprise clients, I recognised that the engineering team's delivery habits, including limited verification and low awareness of failure impact, were still suited to smaller-scale risk. Coached the team to adopt enterprise-grade delivery standards, since a quality issue with one enterprise merchant could affect word-of-mouth reputation with other prospective accounts.
- **Mentoring & Team Development:** Mentor a junior product manager through regular one-on-one sessions, providing coaching on core PM methodologies such as persona thinking and empathetic design. Handed over full ownership of a new POS system version, now managed independently and performing well, and instilled a QA-driven gatekeeper mindset: verify thoroughly and consider downstream impact before shipping.
- **Leading Without Formal Authority:** Lead cross-functional alignment with designers and engineers on major UI changes for new features. For smaller updates, work independently using Claude for Design and the team's existing templates, building prototypes when requirements are clear to accelerate alignment ahead of formal design work.

- **Crisis & Incident Management:** After a separate team's deployment disrupted the inventory product during a critical month-end stock take across roughly 1,300 outlets, the period that most directly affects outlet KPIs and financial reporting, I made the call to temporarily block releases from the other team. Stayed closely aligned with engineering on resolution progress and kept stakeholders updated throughout, applying the fix only once every outlet had completed its count and avoiding extended overtime costs across the network.
- **External Stakeholder Leadership:** Serve as the primary point of contact for enterprise client leadership, including regional managers, operations leads, finance leads, and supply chain leads, across multiple enterprise accounts. Also attend on-site and online meetings with potential clients alongside FeedMe's CTO and Head of Sales, covering requirements gathering, deal scoping, and strategic partnership direction.
- **AI-Driven Productivity:** Apply a mix of AI tools daily to work more efficiently, including coding a custom dashboard for bulk configuration of Flagsmith feature flags, which eliminates repetitive manual setup work.